

Eden, the Garden of God

I often think about when we stand before Him. Somebody said, "You are going to die believing God."

Who wants to die not believing Him?

Hallelujah.

Ten years ago, when my sister came down, we met a lady who did family-tree searches. She searched and found a nest of our relatives in Texas, born in Fort Stockton. She tracked a cousin down in Tulsa. My dad's sister came down to see the cousin, and we got to meet.

Then I found out my dad died in the veterans' hospital in Muskogee, just fifty miles from me. It was during the glory days when I was on television here, doing the monthly rallies, had my own planes and all of that. I did not even know he was there.

There is only one person who has the power to stop me.

It is not the devil. I celebrated his victory two thousand years ago. Time does not seem to help him any. He is still defeated.

Amen.

You have no idea what kind of rebellion will be put down and finished when this is over and he is incarcerated. He will roam nowhere anymore.

Jesus said the devil is the father of lies. He was the father of the first lie and the father of all iniquity. It came from one place: him.

In the price Jesus paid, He destroyed him who had the power of death, even the devil. When Satan was stripped and told to eat the dust of the earth, that meant he could not operate except through flesh. "Dust thou art, and unto dust shalt thou return."

He cannot come down Interstate 5 murdering each city as he goes through. One angel of his class could go through and lay eighty thousand Assyrians to rest when they were threatening Israel. They woke up dead. They were on the wrong side. That is the power of those angels.

If Lucifer still had that kind of freedom, you would know when he was in town. But he was reduced to eating the dust of the earth. To do his filthiest work, he has to have a Hitler. He has to have a Cain, whose desires he can rule over, to start a bloodline that would eventually try to take the whole world.

Nevertheless, he is finally incarcerated. All evil will be put down. The source of it will be gone.

So the price Jesus paid was much more than you can conceive. If He says you have victory, I would believe it. You would not even be graced to stand on this planet had Satan not been reduced and defeated in his power.

So why am I only going to enjoy walking-around freedom while he is reduced to eating the dust of the earth? I am going to enjoy ordering-him-around freedom. I am going to enjoy "turn loose of my friends" freedom.

It is an insult to think he is going to ruin my life. What an insult.

There is only one person who has the power to stop me. It is not the devil. God does not even have the power to stop you, because He is bound by His Word. He is not a man that He can lie.

Therefore, what He told you is going to come to pass. What He promised, He cannot renege on. He cannot alter Himself by any sovereignty into something He is not.

What He promised you will come to pass if you believe it. Therefore, He cannot stop you.

Who has enough power to stop me?

You.

The devil has to convince you. You are the only one who has the power to stop yourself. God is bound to what you believe.

You say, "I do not believe it."

He says, "That is too bad."

He Himself is bound to what you believe.

When Jesus addressed the devil, He said to be wise as serpents. They had the serpents in their part of the country in mind, cobras. I have in mind a boa or an anaconda dropping out of a limb on you, surrounding you and constricting. Every time you breathe even half a breath out, it takes the room away from you. It squeezes again. You cannot breathe back in. Every move you make, it constricts and locks you there. Then when you quit struggling, it circles around and begins to swallow you headfirst.

When He put a label on the old serpent, He put a good one on him.

A rattlesnake's poison is a pure form of protein. It is digestive. It starts digesting you before he ever swallows you. It starts breaking you down.

When Jesus used those no-armed things, quiet and lethal, He said we needed to be wise as serpents. He never told you to be ignorant of Satan's devices.

People say, "I just do not talk about the devil." They have already been deceived into thinking that if they ignore him, he will go away. One of the wisest sayings on his behalf is, "Do not learn about him."

The devil says, "I coined that. I did not want them to know anything about me. I coined that."

Somebody says, "I do not give him any glory in my life."

Do you think I do?

Jesus said to be wise as a serpent. In other words, you need to know your enemy. He said wise as a serpent because Satan has a whole arsenal full of weaponry that can only be defeated by the wisdom of God.

Most people yelling, "I have power over the devil," are screaming it out of a stronghold he put them in years ago.

One of his most valuable tools is not only sin. The devil has a lot of holy men who will kill you in the name of their god and not yours. These men lock themselves up in rooms and chant all their lives. You want to talk about sold out? Religion is one of his most powerful weapons.

The reason is that God is bound to what you believe. He will try everything He can to get the truth to you. But what you end up believing is what He is bound by. He has to stand back and let you go to hell, or to your grave, or anywhere you want to go.

But if you decide to believe Him, all the corporate structure of heaven has been put at your disposal. He called it moving mountains. All things are possible to him who believes, and nothing shall be impossible to you.

To have that kind of walk, you have to get your motives and everything straightened out. It is not to put more rings on your fingers and Cadillacs under your body.

The two wealthiest men in the world did not know what to do with it. It did not impress them at all. Adam and Noah owned the world. What do you do when you own the world? Sell it?

The exaltation from wealth is only in proportion to population. Who are you going to impress when you own the world?

Jesus said to be wise as serpents and harmless as doves because most of what the devil has done and does is not merely the obvious things. We know stalkers who stalk your children are wrong. We know perversion is wrong. We know murder is wrong. We do not have a problem with that. The devil usually does not go out of his way to teach you those things are wrong. In fact, he likes to herd you into them and then condemn you to death.

It is a rare exception for a man to come forward like Carlton Pearson and declare the salvation of all. On one end of the cross, at least he is not leaving Jesus out. It is just another alternative deceptive plan of Satan.

To step forward and say, "You have the same God," is one thing. Carlton's teaching was not that there are many roads to God. He said Jesus did pay the price. By one man death came upon all men, and by one Man, the Second Adam, he claimed life would eventually come upon all men whether they accepted Him or not.

I do not know if he has the devil saved yet or not, but he will probably be next. That is ultimate reconciliation.

When I started getting to know the nature of God through His love, praying in tongues delivered me to the worship limb. I thought I was going to do some good teaching on it, but really it was to acquaint me with the Father. Not only God, but God as Father.

I knew God better than I knew the Father. He wanted me to know the Father. That is what the private worship did.

The more His nature poured into mine, the more I was able to understand the things that work in His nature. When He began to show me the kind of love He has, it increased my faith incredibly.

After He increased my faith to a certain level, I was having fun. At Bakersfield, at a Bible college, six people came in on crutches and six left without them. One woman came through with her son, who had torn or pulled a tendon. We sat him down, prayed for him in the office on his way through, and he was healed.

I was like a kid in a candy shop.

When I realized there was a source that caused God's motivation for a person to turn into power, I wanted to keep the conduit open. Finding out that my new nature is the reservoir, an unlimited reservoir that could pool His love, I wanted more.

Then the counterfeiter came.

I did not realize what was happening at first. When I got baptized in that first real good dose of love that turned into power, the counterfeiter came and said, "How can all these people He loves so much go to hell?"

I know what got Carlton.

There is a danger in understanding more of His love. The counterfeiter has a program for that. He will take you until you cannot see how a world can be lost, and you will be an ultimate-reconciliation fellow before it is over.

One thing you never want to do is quit praying in tongues, because praying in tongues is a revelation gift that inoculates you against deception.

Hallelujah.

Praying in tongues delivered me to that key that is increasing the love of God in me, but it has also protected me from taking the love of God down a limb of deception. Do not stop letting the Holy Ghost pray the mind of Christ into your life in power.

There is only one person who has the power to stop me. He is the one. I would like to blame you. If I cannot blame you, I would like to blame my dog. If I cannot blame my dog, I would like to blame my busy schedule. If I cannot frame that, what am I going to frame?

You mean He made every provision? He suffered, stood in the place of, and took every defeat? He took the fullness of it because the fullness of God's love manifested. God cannot love you any more than He did when He sent Him to the cross.

Someone says, "He does not love me very much."

He manifested Himself at the cross. He cannot love you more. Whatever you are doing, whatever you did, and whatever failure you are heading for, it was already laid upon Him in its fullness. In fact, the great victories you can have are what He had to pay for.

Tell me, how can He love you more? He cannot.

Here is wisdom: if I were you, I would stop and start receiving the love.

Of course, grace and mercy are going to follow us to heaven. He will wipe our tears away and burn all our wrong believing in the trash, but we will be saved, as by fire. That is a purging fire that burns to draw us out and leaves what you did that was pure. If you have a few things left, you get a little reward. If you have a lot left, a lot of reward. If you have no reward, at least you are there.

I do not care how bad that moment is. I will survive it because I am going to be there.

You cannot make Him love you more, but you can love Him. You can receive more of what He already has for you. He has already loved you. It is not future tense. It is past tense. You can receive all of it you want in this lifetime.

And I am warning you: when you get like Him, you are going to give the wrong things up and hold on to the right things. You are going to start loving people, and you are going to come to a place in power where you will do something even about their suffering.

Lift those hands up. I cannot help it. I am a hopeless addict.

Hallelujah. Glory be to God forever.

For a little while I thought I was not going to get to any of this. I could tell by the look on your face that even though you were enjoying the daylights out of the whipping we gave the devil, you still had that look: "Are we going to get to the Tree of Life?"

We were just eating off one of its limbs.

Father, I glorify You, love You, and magnify You, Jesus. Some things belong to You in these days. Probably one of the greatest things we can worship You for is truth, and we do. Everything else is produced from knowing that You did it. I thank You for miracles, healings, and power, but Father, I thank You for truth that causes them, sustains us, and inoculates us against deception. You said we could know the truth. With all my heart I worship You, glorify You, magnify You, and extol You.

Hallelujah.

Go to Hebrews 9:23. Then, of course, we will be over in Ezekiel 28 for a minute.

The Eden that Satan covered was the same kind of thing as the garden Adam was put in to dress. Lucifer was the anointed cherub that covereth, and what he covered was the Garden of Eden that God had long before He built us the house we live in.

That should not surprise you, because when God talks about redemption, He talks about the things here being a pattern of something that already existed.

God had an Eden. He had a house. Why would our house and the Eden He made for us not be a copy of the one He has?

Before Jesus shed His blood, animal blood cleansed the patterns of the things in heaven. A pattern or figure is something made in the likeness of something else. You take the original and cut a pattern from it, and suddenly everybody has a nice little print dress to wear in the 1800s churches. There had to be an original to cut the pattern from.

Paul said animal blood cleansed the holiest of all made with hands, where the high priest entered. All those things were a pattern, and almost all of them could not be cleansed without blood.

Hebrews 9:23 says:

It was therefore necessary that the patterns of things in the heavens should be purified with these; but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these.

The heavenly things were the originals the patterns were cut from.

Verse 24 says:

For Christ is not entered into the holy places made with hands, which are the figures of the true; but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God for us.

The place made with hands was the pattern, the figure. It looked like the true. But Jesus entered into heaven itself to appear in the presence of God for us.

So if God had a house, and the place He lived was covered by the most powerful class of angel, the cherubim, then God's Eden was covered by this anointed cherub. This was His house.

Would it not stand to reason that when His creation was almost finished and He built our house, He made a garden called Eden and put us in it? It had to be a pattern of something that existed. God only knows the millions or billions of years that this garden existed, the one Satan, or Lucifer the anointed cherub, covered.

We had a house just like it until we were thrown out of it.

What do you think is going to happen when this is all over? When death and hell deliver themselves up, the great white throne is done, and God looks into the universe one time and everything flees away, everything passes away with fervent heat, what kind of house do you think

we are going to get back?

It is going to be a homecoming.

There will be a doormat outside: "Home Sweet Eden."

Look at Ezekiel 28:13:

Thou hast been in Eden the garden of God; every precious stone was thy covering...

It lists sardius, topaz, diamond, beryl, onyx, jasper, sapphire, emerald, carbuncle, and gold.

Then it says:

The workmanship of thy tabrets and of thy pipes was prepared in thee in the day that thou wast created.

If you successfully break down that part, you will find out the pipes were not things sticking out of his body like an old organ in those monstrous churches. It was in him. When he worshiped, you want to talk about covering. He could open creation up. It was probably something to behold.

I know this about Satan: anybody who has talent has the mark of the call to open creation up to worship. Elvis Presley got his roots in choirs. Anybody who has talent has the call to open creation up to worship, whether they are born again or not.

When you get born again, that is what that talent is for: to open creation up.

Talent is the mark of the call. It is not the equipping. The equipping is when you go on and can get God to come when you sing. That is not a talent contest. It does not come outside of you spending time with Him yourself.

Some people say, "I have that call." Others say, "I do not."

I might not be a worship leader, but I am a worshiper. I get the same benefit. I might not make a pleasant noise when I sing, but I can get God to come.

In Lucifer's beauty, part of his fall and his wisdom was, "I will be like the Most High. I will exalt my throne above the stars of God." Part of it is that he wanted to be worshiped. He wanted to divert some of that worship to himself. That was evident in the Garden of Eden, and it was evident in the wilderness where Jesus stood against him to give us a standing better than all the power the devil has.

The last temptation was spirit, soul, and body. Body: turn the stones into bread and feed yourself if You are the Son of God. The emotional realm of the soul: jump off the temple; it is written that the angels will bear You up. Spirit: behold all the kingdoms of the world.

Where do you think Satan was doing this from? Where are you going to see all the kingdoms of the world from, Lucifer? He has himself a throne and a high seat of religion. He loves to rule from there.

Brother Denny Cramer once said Jesus came to get him, but he felt funny about it. He had been to heaven several times. He said this time, when Jesus came, he felt uneasy. It looked just like Him. But when the devil knew Denny knew who he was, he did not try to deceive him anymore.

You know what he said? "You lost your daughter to death in a car wreck. Your leg is lame. You are suffering. You are in pain. Your enemies are always against you. Your circumstances are always bad. Look at the overall picture. What has God really ever done for you?"

I said, "What did you say?"

He said, "I would not answer it."

That is where the devil took Jesus: to that high mountain where he rules religions from. He showed Him the kingdoms of the world and said, "Look at the glory of these. Not just the power. I will give You the glory of them. You will be the next thing to..."

Do you want to know what Adam withstood? What makes you think the garden he was tested in was so much different from the one Jesus was tested in? What do you think happened? Do you think it was a walk in the park?

Satan said, "Look at the glory. All these people will serve you. You will be so exalted. You will be like the Most High. All you have to do is get down and worship me."

What do you think he wanted?

Why do you think the devil is so successful taking men off into self-exaltation? They end up thinking all of this is about them and what people can do for them.

We have an Eden that was God's house. He made us one just like His. If ours is a pattern of His, what do you think it had to have in it?

Revelation says that those who overcome will freely be able to eat from the Tree of Life. The indication is not just once. We will freely take whatever this tree is providing for us.

So what would make you think that if there was one in our Eden, there was not one in God's Eden? I get so excited I can hardly stand myself, much less ask you to.

If our house is a pattern, the figure of His, a copy, and we had a tree here, what makes you think there was not a tree there? What makes you think creation could not come and freely partake of God as much as they wanted to through this Tree of Life?

Hallelujah, Jesus.

We had one. God had to shut it down, put guards up, run us out of the garden, and cut us off so we would not eat of it anymore. He had a reason for doing that.

Looking again at Ezekiel 28, the tabrets and pipes were prepared in him the day he was created. Verse 14 says:

Thou art the anointed cherub that covereth; and I have set thee so.

I always wondered what he covered. The same reason God put Adam in the garden was to dress it. Lucifer was the anointed cherub, and it is interesting that he was in the same class as the angels who guarded the tree afterward.

The tree was not guarded against a fallen little man named Adam who had lost all his power. It took an angelic class to stop Satan's re-entry into the tree with Adam and Eve.

That gets nearer the end of the story, but note this: he was the anointed cherub that covered. That is the same class of cherubim that guarded the tree in the Garden of Eden.

The verse continues:

Thou wast upon the holy mountain of God; thou hast walked up and down in the midst of the stones of fire.

Then verse 15:

Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.

One thing I like about this word "created" is that in one sense, you and I were created. We are here now, and at one time no human was. But in Hebrews, when the writer explains how we received a more excellent inheritance than the angels, he defines the difference in where each came from.

To the angels He says:

Who maketh his angels spirits, and his ministers a flame of fire.

But to the Son He says:

Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee.

Angels were created. We were born.

That is why you had to come through a single strand of DNA called Adam. The creation of man was laid out in a little program you cannot even see. God did not make Eve's body out of the dust of the earth and then blow into her life. He reached into Adam's rib and got his DNA. He altered one chromosome, and there was the variation.

We are so close in creation. It was a small alteration. Yet Eve came through the same DNA. That is why He did not make her body out of the ground.

How do I know these things? Because I lay in my prayer room and prayed them out in the Holy Ghost, and He told me. God is not stupid. He does things in more order than you dreamed of.

I said, "God, how can this be? She came through his DNA and You altered one chromosome? You mean she was in his DNA?"

He said, "Yes. In the beginning, male and female created He them."

She was in him.

Someone tried to break that down and said God created Eve's spirit and it possessed Adam's body until He pulled it out. No, she existed in his DNA. God changed that one chromosome.

I was lying there debating with myself, saying, "God, we are so different."

He said, "You are not that different."

"We are too."

"No, you are not."

I had to look around for the rating on this statement, but the chromosome DNA is so close. Have you ever asked yourself why men have breasts? I did not think so. They are no good for nothing.

So Lucifer was perfect in his ways from the day he was created. We were born. Angels were created.

I like it when Jesus said, "Call no man on this earth father." I am kidding. He also said to honor your father and mother. He was not inciting a debate. What He was saying is this: once you are born again, your natural father is no more your father than Joseph was Jesus' Father. You have been born from above. But your natural father still has all the honor of bringing you into existence, or there would have been nothing to be born again.

He also said, "Call no man on this earth teacher."

I said, "Now wait a minute. What do I do?"

He explained that in Corinthians when Paul said, "If you did receive something, why are you acting as though you did not receive it?" Have you ever wondered about that play on words?

When Jesus said, "Call no man teacher," He was saying that if you have original revelation, it did not come from that man, and if it did, it is probably wrong. If it is truth, it originated with the One who is the Teacher. So if you are teaching something He is not teaching, you are not a teacher. If you do get a revelation from Jesus, why are you running around strutting like it came from you?

When God created angels, they were full-service ready, full grown and ready for service. There was no growing. There they are.

Are they male or female? They are neither, though masculine. We do not have a definition. Most of their names are male, but then again, who thought male names up? It could have gone the other way, and Henry, James, and all of that could have been women's names. That is just our language.

I can tell you this: they are not fat little babies with wings that defy the laws of physics. The angels I have seen in paintings would have to be supernatural because they could not do anything for you. A little fat baby comes on the scene. So what? Little wings barely clear their little heads.

I love babies. Their heads are almost as wide as their shoulders. When they get in a fight, they can barely walk in their diapers. They rear back so far with their hand that they fall over backward.

Do you not just love little strands of DNA?

Ezekiel says:

Thou wast perfect in thy ways from the day that thou wast created, till iniquity was found in thee.

Iniquity originated in him.

When Jesus said Satan is the father of lies, He meant Satan did not continue a long line of fathers of lies. Satan was not created from creations that fell to lying. He was the father of it. All iniquity originated with him. Before him, there was not any in the universe. All of it came through him.

That is what Ezekiel means when it says he was perfect in his ways from the day he was created until iniquity was found in him.

To confirm that, go to John 8:42:

Jesus said unto them, If God were your Father, ye would love me: for I proceeded forth and came from God; neither came I of myself, but he sent me.

Verse 43:

Why do ye not understand my speech? even because ye cannot hear my word.

Verse 44:

Ye are of your father the devil, and the lusts of your father ye will do.

That simply means all iniquity originated with him, and now they are in iniquity. He is the father of it.

Jesus continues:

He was a murderer from the beginning, and abode not in the truth, because there is no truth in him.

When he speaks a lie, he speaks of his own, for he is a liar and the father of it.

Notice the wording. There was not a long line of liars before him. He was the father of it. All of it had its origin and beginning with him.

Now notice Jesus says Satan was a murderer from the beginning. Whose beginning? In Lucifer's own beginning, he was perfect in his ways from the day he was created. So whose beginning?

The same as Genesis 1:1 and John 1:1: "In the beginning." The three persons who make up the Godhead, acting as one, created the heavens and the earth. He was talking about our beginning. It does not mean the beginning of God. God had no beginning. He always was. You cannot understand that, but forever He existed. Before you were, before this universe was, He already was.

The beginning Jesus is talking about is our universe and our creation. Before anything we understand to exist had a beginning, God created our heavens, our earth, our creation, and put us in it. Satan being a liar from the beginning and the father of it means that when he introduced his lie to us, iniquity was already in him.

In God's Eden, probably billions of years ago, God only knows how long ago, iniquity was found in him. But it was already in him from the beginning of our beginning, and that is why he introduced it to our creation. He was the father of it.

Can you imagine Jesus giving you power over that eternal creature? Satan loses. The only thing he can do is turn you against yourself. He has to get you to defeat yourself. He knows what you are sitting on, even if you do not.

He thought he had God. But God caused the same us that Satan came and got to be born again. Who is smart enough to have you born again back into the family you were lost out of? You are the same person, but a new creation. The old man was sentenced to death, and Jesus paid the penalty for all of us so we could be born again back into God's family with an even greater inheritance facing us than we left behind.

What kind of God is so smart that to get you back, you actually had to be born again?

I am home. The doormat says, "Welcome home, son, to Eden."

Why do you think Lucifer is loosed? God had him chained for a millennium. Why turn him loose? He goes out and makes war against nations. They march against Israel. What is the deal?

If you have a guy chained, leave him. Is that not your way of thinking? Why turn him loose on the world again?

You ask why. Do you think I know? You are sure I do.

Jesus is coming back with His bride. That is us. He is the Second Adam, and we are His bride. We are in the garden. Lucifer is out.

We have not lived that day out yet. The closest anyone came was Methuselah at 969 years, Jared at 962, and Noah at 950. Nobody has lived the day out. "In the day that thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die." Nobody has lived it out.

We are going to be in the garden with Adam. At the end of the thousand years, that day will be lived out. Lucifer is going to come back into the garden. This time the Last Adam is going to do what the first one was supposed to do.

He is going to throw him out.